

F1 TECH THAT DID NOT LAND WELL

Only some people liked it

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1

THE X WINGS

It might sound like the name of a TV show, but this F1 design innovation took the world by storm when it was first introduced in the year 1997 by the Tyrrell F1 team. They had been lacking grip in their cars and were not able to compete at the top of the grid despite having a fairly powerful car otherwise. Dubbed the Tyrrell 025, the car sporting repurposed wings, called the X Wings, became a benchmark for other teams to match up to. Teams like Ferrari, Jordan, Prost, and Sauber also tried their hands at adding these extra wings to their cars for some added downforce. However, as time passed the Formula 1 governing body decided that they will not allow teams to have X Wings fitted cars as it was a safety hazard. The ban wasn't contested as much as later Tyrrell, the team that had introduced this in the first place, came out and accepted that the added wings were causing problems for their drivers.



2

DOUBLE CHASSIS

As absurd it may seem, but F1 teams in the olden days were insanely innovative when it came to designing their vehicles. Their ideas went to the extent where the Lotus F1 team decided to have two separate chassis in their car, the Lotus 88 in 1981. The idea was that while the outer shell would cover the vehicle and provide the team with all the benefits of ground effect, which by then had been outlawed. The inner chassis would house the driver and all the machinery and ensure that the driver was protected from the absurd forces exerted onto their body from the downforce that the car was experiencing. This design by Colin Chapman was contested by the teams and the FIA asked Lotus to revert to the single chassis design. While teams were not against this innovative design, their concern was the amount of money they'd all have to shell out to match what Lotus had done with their car.